A FREE GUIDE FROM MASHA BLAIR

Stop Chasing, Start Choosing

How to date after 40 without losing yourself.

A note from me

I left a 17-year marriage at 44. I took a full year to heal before I went on a single date. Then I went on more than 60 of them.

Here's what I noticed, on my own dates and in the messages women send me: most of us show up to dating like it's an audition. We try to be easy-going, agreeable, low-maintenance. We wait for his text and read meaning into every word. We keep asking "Does he like me?" and forget to ask "Do I like him?"

That's chasing. And chasing makes you smaller.

This guide is about switching that question back. You're not here to be picked. You're here to pick.

> *Men don't chase convenient. They chase magnetic.*

Are you chasing?

Be honest with yourself. Do any of these sound familiar?

- [ ] You check your phone for his text, and his silence ruins your day.
- [ ] You say "I'm easy, anywhere is fine" when you actually care.
- [ ] You offer to meet halfway, plan the date, or split the bill so he doesn't feel pressure.
- [ ] You stay on a date you're not enjoying so you don't hurt his feelings.
- [ ] You keep quiet about what you want so you don't seem "too picky."
- [ ] You start planning a future with him after one good date.

If two or more sound like you, nothing is wrong with you. You were trained to be convenient. Let's undo it.

7 shifts from chasing to choosing

You don't need all seven before your next date. Pick one and practice it. Choosing is a muscle, and it gets stronger every time you use it.

1. **Build a life you love first.**
   When your life is full, you're naturally not always available, so you never have to play games or pretend to be busy. A man who wants to be part of that life has to make room for himself in it.

2 **Know what you want, and say it.**

In your profile and on the date. A man once asked where I wanted to go for breakfast. I said, "Pick a nice place." Then I checked the menu and asked if they had real food, because pastries don't work for me. I'm not afraid to look picky. I am picky. If he has a problem with that, good. Now I know.

3 **Let him plan, and let him make the effort.**

Pursuit is his job. He picks the place, he makes the plan, he comes to you. Be careful with the man who asks you to meet halfway just so he doesn't have to drive 30 more minutes. Low effort at the start rarely turns into high effort later.

4 **Stop auditioning. Enjoy, observe, receive.**

You're not on the date to impress him. You're there to enjoy yourself, to watch how he treats you and the waiter, and to receive his attention. Feminine energy is receiving. Let him do the doing.

5 **Keep your rules, especially at the start.**

Mine keep me safe and keep my standards from slipping: meet in a public place, drive yourself, don't get drunk, and skip the "let's just grab a drink" first date. Rules are guides, not a cage. But the one time I broke mine for a very special man? Nothing good happened.

6 **Go slow.**

No deadline. No pressure to sleep with him by date three, no rush to be exclusive. Slow gives you time to see who he really is. A man who's serious about you will wait. A man who won't was never serious.

7 **Walk away without guilt.**

Choosing means saying no, too. These days it takes me about ten minutes to know when a man isn't a romantic match. I can still be kind and enjoy the evening. I just don't keep seeing someone out of politeness. Every "no" makes room for the right "yes."

The fears that keep us chasing

"If I don't text him first, he'll lose interest."

Then he wasn't that interested. I'm direct: if I want to text a man, I do. But I also let him chase me, because a man who wants you will reach out. Give him the chance to.

"I'm too old to be picky."

You've lived long enough to know exactly what you want and what you won't tolerate. That isn't being picky. That's wisdom, and you earned it.

"If I have standards, I'll end up alone."

Standards don't scare off good men. They scare off the wrong ones. And a happy single life beats a convenient relationship every time.

"What if he's the one and I let him go?"

I once got my heart broken by a man, and then I realized I didn't really miss him. I missed the version of me I was around him. That feeling is what you're choosing, and you can create it again, with someone else or on your own.

Your next step

Pick one shift and practice it on your next date. Just one. Then notice how differently he shows up, and how differently you feel.

If you want the whole system, my course walks you through it: who you become first, then how to date with clear standards and enjoy it.

With love, Masha

The course: dating-goddess.com/course
Free exit guide: dating-goddess.com/exit-guide
Instagram: @masha_blair_goddess

This guide shares my personal experience. It isn't professional or mental health advice. When you meet someone new, put your safety first.